Paul Franklin, Oliver James, Eugénie von Tunzelmann: The Visual-Effects Team

One day in mid-May 2013 Chris phoned me. He wanted to send a guy named Paul Franklin over to my home to discuss the computer graphics for *Interstellar*. Paul came the next day, and we spent a delightful two hours brainstorming in my home office. He was modest in demeanor, by contrast with Chris's forcefulness. He was brilliant. He showed a deep knowledge of the relevant science, despite having majored in the arts in college.

As Paul was leaving, I asked him which graphics company he was thinking of using for the visual effects. "Mine," he responded, mildly. "And what company is that?" I asked, naively. "Double Negative. We have 1000 employees in London and 200 in Singapore."

After Paul departed I Googled him and discovered that not only had he cofounded Double Negative, he had also won an Academy Award for the visual effects in Chris's movie *Inception*. "It's time I get educated about this movie business," I murmured to myself.

In a video conference a few weeks later, Paul introduced me to the London-based leaders of his *Interstellar* visual-effects team. Most relevant to me were Oliver James, the chief scientist who would write computer code underlying the visual effects; and Eugénie von Tunzelmann, who led the artistic team that would take Oliver's computer code and add extensive artistic twists to produce compelling images for the movie.